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The main stories

- **Microsoft is previewing security information and event management (SIEM) features in Defender for its top licences.** Microsoft calls it a benefit of those licences. The preview is open to customers without Microsoft Sentinel.
- **Okta launched AI-agent features at its Oktane conference.** Okta says three are generally available, one since August. Agent Gateway, which sits between agents and the tools they call, is planned for this quarter.
- **Okta and 11 other companies formed the Blueprint Alliance on securing AI agents.** CrowdStrike, Zscaler and Proofpoint joined. Microsoft, Palo Alto Networks and SailPoint are not among the founding members.
- **Cyera and Island each raised \$400 million.** Cyera says it is valued at over \$12 billion; Island says \$6.4 billion. Evolution Equity Partners led Island's round and Cyera's Series G.
- **Zscaler's chief revenue officer is stepping down.** Ross Tackett takes over on 1 October. Zscaler's shares fell 8.6% on Friday morning, Proactive reports.
- **Proofpoint announced a combined data-security and AI-security system.** It expects the system to be available by the end of 2026.
- **Accenture's Dragos, runZero and NetRise deals are complete.** Our 19 September summary said Accenture had published no completion notice. That was wrong: Accenture had added one to its June announcement.
- **Gartner published a new quadrant for AI application security.** Zenity and Noma Security each say they are a startup "Market Shaper" in it.

Our view: Microsoft and Okta are both adding AI-era security to licences customers already pay for. Microsoft includes the SIEM features. Okta includes basic agent sign-on but charges per user for its wider agent product.

Security operations

Microsoft previews SIEM features in Defender for its top licences

- On 23 September Microsoft announced a public preview of an Integrated Security Operations Center inside Microsoft Defender. It brings Microsoft Sentinel's SIEM features, such as case management and automation rules, into Defender.
- Microsoft calls it "a benefit" for Microsoft 365 E5, E7 and Defender Suite customers, not a new product. It is in preview.
- **Who can use it now:** eligible customers without an active Sentinel workspace. Existing Sentinel customers may move from 15 November.

- **Price:** Microsoft's own security data is included, kept for 30 days now and 90 days from 15 November.
- From 1 October, Microsoft lists \$2.40 per GB for data from other vendors, and says regional pricing may vary.
- IDC, a market-research firm, told CSO Online that companies with many non-Microsoft systems need "a real total cost-of-ownership comparison".
- **Our view:** independent SIEM vendors sell into many of the same E5 accounts. They now compete with a bundled offer and a published price for outside data.
- **Watch:** the 1 October price start and the 15 November move for Sentinel customers.

Sources: *Microsoft Tech Community, Microsoft Learn, Microsoft Security blog, CSO Online.*

Other security-operations news

- **Palo Alto Networks** launched Unit 42 Continuous Frontier AI Defense, an attack-testing subscription. It says the service is built around frontier models, including Anthropic's Claude Mythos 5 and OpenAI's GPT-5.6-Cyber.
- **Splunk:** a 24 September partner blog calls Agent Launchpad, Splunk's tool for building agents, "newly-GA" (generally available). We found no dated release. Cisco's 15 September release said it was coming later this year.
- **SentinelOne** says its managed threat hunting for Amazon Web Services (AWS), Microsoft Azure and Google Cloud accounts is now generally available to existing Wayfinder threat-hunting customers.

Sources: *Palo Alto Networks, Splunk, SentinelOne.*

Identity

Okta launches AI-agent features; most runtime controls come later

- **Generally available now, Okta says:** Agent SSO (single sign-on for agents), Agent-to-Agent Connections and Resource Access Certifications.
- **Planned for this quarter:** Agent Gateway, which sits between agents and the tools they call and logs every call.
- **Planned for the fourth quarter:** extending Okta's kill switch, which cuts off an agent's access, to the Agent Gateway.
- **Finding unmanaged agents on employee devices:** Okta's investor sheet plans general availability in the fourth quarter for the CrowdStrike-based version, and early 2027 for Okta's own. Its press release said the third quarter.
- Threat detection built with Permiso, which Okta acquired, is planned to enter early access in the fourth quarter, in the US and Canada only.

Sources: *Okta, Okta investor sheet.*

Okta's chief executive gives a rough number on agent pricing

- Okta's investor summit on 23 September gave no new financial targets. The only document Okta posted for it was the product sheet.
- Chief executive Todd McKinnon said agent security is priced per user today.
- Recalling "a few specific sizable deals", he said "if the overall platform or Okta is 4, the AI agent part is 1 or 1.5".
- He called it "a small sample size", an Investing.com transcript shows. By our arithmetic, that is an uplift of 25% to 37.5%. He said the model will change and will not stay per user.
- Okta named Dell, Ramp and Yahoo as customers of its agent product. Okta says it is adding support for customers whose main sign-in system is another provider, such as Microsoft Entra ID.
- **Why it matters:** this is a rare vendor figure for what agent identity adds to a deal.

Sources: *Investing.com transcript, Okta investor events.*

The Blueprint Alliance

- Okta formed the alliance with Amazon Web Services, CrowdStrike, Databricks, Docker, Google Cloud, Lovable, Proofpoint, Salesforce, ServiceNow, Wiz and Zscaler.
- Members agree shared principles: each agent has its own identity, access fits the task, and access can be cut off instantly. Okta calls it an open, multi-vendor reference architecture.
- **Our view:** CrowdStrike joined even though it launched a competing agent-identity product on 2 September. Microsoft, Palo Alto Networks, Cisco and SailPoint, which all sell identity products, did not.

Source: *Okta.*

Other identity news

- **Omada**, a Danish identity-governance vendor, acquired EmpowerID, which Omada says lets customers decide in real time what AI agents may do. Omada gave no terms.
- **Delinea** named former Dropbox finance chief Timothy Regan as Chief Financial Officer. Delinea says it passed \$500 million in annual recurring revenue in 2025.
- **BeyondTrust** says it launched integrations that send identity data from its Pathfinder platform into CrowdStrike's SIEM product.

Sources: *Omada, Delinea, BeyondTrust.*

Data security and insider risk

Cyera adds \$400 million from Goldman Sachs Alternatives

- Goldman Sachs Alternatives invested \$400 million as an extension of Cyera's Series G, which Evolution Equity Partners led in June.
- Cyera says it is "valued at over \$12 billion". In June it announced \$600 million at \$12 billion. **Our view:** Cyera has not disclosed a clear increase since June.
- Cyera completed its \$1 billion purchase of Oasis Security on 3 September. It says the new money speeds up its work "to bring data and identity together".

Sources: *Cyera, Cyera, June.*

Proofpoint announces a data and AI security system for year-end

- At Protect 2026 on 22 September, Proofpoint announced three agents for detecting, investigating and reducing data risk, plus rules written in plain language.
- Proofpoint says these are "expected to be available by year-end 2026". A planned SailPoint integration has the same timing.
- **Available now, Proofpoint says:** four of its data-security products on AWS Marketplace, announced in a 24 September blog.
- **Why it matters:** Proofpoint is building out data security in public while reported talks to buy Varonis stay unconfirmed.

Sources: *Proofpoint, Proofpoint, AWS Marketplace.*

Microsoft announces network-level data loss prevention for agents

- Microsoft's September security blog says Purview's network-level data loss prevention is "now generally available" for people and for agents acting on their behalf.
- Last week we reported it from Microsoft's release notes. Microsoft's public roadmap still lists the item as in development.
- Microsoft's roadmap plans data loss prevention through Island's browser for June 2027, and lists it as in development.

Sources: *Microsoft Security blog, Microsoft 365 roadmap.*

Other data-security news

- **Nightfall AI** says its expanded Okta integration is generally available. Its integration with Okta for AI Agents is targeted for the fourth quarter.
- **Gurukul** says its product for detecting risky AI use is generally available. Blocking is in preview.
- **Cyberhaven's** Claude Enterprise connector appears to be available. Cyberhaven has a live setup guide, and Anthropic lists Cyberhaven as a partner. Cyberhaven's newsroom has no launch

announcement.

Sources: *Nightfall AI, Gurukul, Cyberhaven, Anthropic.*

Secure edge

Island raises \$400 million and says it has built a secure-edge architecture

- Island raised a \$400 million Series F at a \$6.4 billion valuation, led by Evolution Equity Partners. Island says its valuation has more than doubled since 2024.
- Island began with a secure enterprise browser. Chief executive Mike Fey says it has since “built a next-generation SASE architecture from the endpoint outward”.
- SASE (secure access service edge) is cloud-delivered network security, the market where Zscaler, Netskope and Palo Alto Networks compete.

Sources: *Island, SecurityWeek.*

Zscaler changes its sales chief

- Ross Tackett, Zscaler’s head of worldwide sales, becomes Chief Revenue Officer on 1 October. Mike Rich steps down and advises the company until 31 December.
- Zscaler’s release cites personal reasons. Its filing with the US securities regulator gives no reason.
- Shares fell 8.6% on Friday morning, Proactive reports. Proactive says the investment bank Jefferies sees added execution risk from the timing but does not expect major disruption.
- **Watch:** Zscaler’s Investor Day on 6 October, which will cover strategy and financial outlook.

Sources: *SEC filing, Zscaler, Proactive via Yahoo Finance, GlobeNewswire.*

Akamai signs a computing contract with Anthropic worth about \$11.6 billion

- This is not a security deal, but at about \$11.6 billion it is a large one for a secure-edge vendor.
- Anthropic committed to pay about \$11.6 billion for dedicated cloud computing, under two plans that each run an initial seven years, Akamai’s filing says. Payment depends on Akamai meeting delivery conditions.
- Akamai says the deal could grow to about \$20 billion.
- Anthropic received a warrant for up to about 5% of Akamai at \$111.33 a share. Akamai says the deal has no impact on its 2026 revenue guidance.
- Anthropic may end the contract if a direct competitor of Anthropic takes control of Akamai.
- Shares rose as much as 16.4% on 25 September before paring the gain to about 8%, CNBC reports.
- **Our view:** that clause narrows who could buy Akamai. The deal also pulls Akamai’s spending towards AI computing.

Sources: *SEC filing, Akamai, CNBC.*

Other secure-edge news

- **Netskope:** ICONIQ funds distributed another 5.5 million Netskope shares to their own investors on 22 September, the same amount as on 16 September.
- **Netskope's** Agent Action Control is still planned for the end of the current quarter. Some finance sites say it "rolled out"; Netskope's own wording has not changed.
- **Palo Alto Networks** introduced monthly pay-as-you-go pricing for Prisma SASE, its secure-edge product, for qualified managed-service partners only. Its blog is dated 17 September.

Sources: *SEC filing, ICONIQ, Netskope, Palo Alto Networks.*

AI security and funding

Gartner's new quadrant for AI application security

- Gartner published an Emerging Market Quadrant for AI application security in two editions: established vendors on 14 September and startups on 16 September.
- Zenity and Noma Security each say they are a "Market Shaper" in the startup edition. Zenity says Gartner placed only two of nearly 20 startups there.
- Palo Alto Networks and F5 say they are Market Shapers among established vendors.
- Varonis and Proofpoint each say they are "Pace Setters" in the established edition. The report is available only to Gartner clients, and the vendors' summaries of it give no market size.
- Last week we said we had found no analyst category for securing AI tool calls. We missed a relevant one: Gartner's established edition is dated 14 September.
- Varonis quotes Gartner defining the market as protecting "AI applications and agents". Gartner text quoted by Noma Security mentions agents' "tool use".

Sources: *Noma Security, Zenity, Palo Alto Networks, Proofpoint.*

Funding at a glance

Company	What it does	Round	Lead investor
Cyera	Data security	\$400 million Series G extension; over \$12 billion valuation	Goldman Sachs Alternatives
Island	Secure enterprise browser	\$400 million Series F; \$6.4 billion valuation	Evolution Equity Partners

Company	What it does	Round	Lead investor
Outerlimit	Authorisation for AI agents	\$16 million pre-seed	Not stated; investors include AlbionVC, Evolution Equity Partners and Crane Venture Partners
Kontext Security	Runtime controls for AI agents	\$4 million round	42CAP
TigerByte Cyber	Security for edge and avionics devices	\$3 million seed	Hale Capital Partners

- Evolution Equity Partners led Island's round and Cyera's Series G, and invested in Outerlimit.
- We found no round this week for a vendor that only secures machine identities.

Sources: company announcements and SecurityWeek. Each round is linked in the [full source notes](#).

Acquisitions at a glance

Buyer	Target	Status	Price
Accenture	Dragos (majority stake)	Completed 16 September	About \$4.175 billion for all three, as announced in June
Accenture (both now owned by Dragos)	runZero; NetRise	Completed 17 September; 31 July	Included above
Omada	EmpowerID	Completed 24 September	Terms not given
Upwind	Aegis	Announced 23 September	"Tens of millions" in stock, Calcalist reports
Jamf	Keep Aware	Completed; announced 23 September	Not disclosed
IBM	Logiq Consulting	Announced 24 September	Not disclosed
Nomios	Orbcom	Completed in September; announced 23 September	Not disclosed
A-LIGN	AssurePoint	Announced 22 September	Not disclosed

Buyer	Target	Status	Price
IT Solutions Technology Partners	STACK Cybersecurity	Completed 22 September	Not disclosed
eSentire	An unnamed AI-security start-up	Completed 15 September	Not disclosed

Sources: company announcements, Calcalist and Globes. eSentire's deal predates last week's summary and was not in it.

Stories to watch

Proofpoint and Varonis

- Bloomberg's 2 September report of acquisition talks remains unconfirmed at 24 days. Neither company has commented publicly that we could find.
- Varonis has made no filing of any kind with the US securities regulator since 29 July.
- **Watch for:** a company announcement, a regulatory filing or a denial.

Sources: SEC filing index, Yahoo Finance.

Accenture and Dragos: completed

- Accenture's June announcement now says NetRise closed on 31 July, the Dragos stake on 16 September and runZero on 17 September.
- Dragos announced on 21 September that it had acquired runZero and NetRise, and that it still operates independently.

Sources: Accenture, Dragos.

Deals and launches still pending

- **Quorum Cyber and Ontinue:** signed; no completion announced yet.
- **Okta Agent Gateway:** planned for general availability this quarter, Okta says.
- **Netskope Agent Action Control:** Netskope says it will be available "at the end of the current quarter".
- **Splunk Agent Launchpad:** watch for a dated availability statement from Cisco or Splunk.

Industry groups

- The AI Proving Grounds Consortium still shows seven members. It has made no announcement since its 24 September event.
- The Agentic SOC Alliance page still shows 15 members.

Sources: *AI Proving Grounds Consortium*, *ExtraHop*.

Coming events

- **Zscaler Investor Day, 6 October.**
- **SailPoint Navigate, 5–8 October**, with an analyst and investor webcast on 14 October.
- **Microsoft Ignite, 17–20 November.**

Sources: *Zscaler*, *SailPoint*, *Microsoft*.

Our predictions

- This week changes none of our seven assessments from 12 September. Microsoft's bundled SIEM offer and Okta's agent pricing are evidence we will weigh at the next prediction update, due in early October.

Sources

The [full source notes](#) link each reported development to company announcements, regulatory filings or named publications.